

A Project Report on
AN COMPARATIVE STUDY ON CONSUMER PREFERENCES BETWEEN
APOLLO & MEDPLUS

Submitted to



Osmania University, Hyderabad-500007

In partial fulfilment of the requirements

For the award of the degree of

Bachelor of Commerce (Business Analytics)

Submitted By

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2022-2025

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EXTERNAL GUIDE

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Telangana 500072

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CERTIFICATE

This is to certify that the project work entitled “**AN COMPARATIVE STUDY ON CONSUMER PREFERENCES BETWEEN APOLLO & MEDPLUS**”, is the bonafide work done by, **GAJAWADA BALA SHIVA SAI TEJA** (Roll No: **208522538049**), **GANAPURAM ROHA TEJOO** (Roll No: **208522538050**), **GARLAPATI SAMPATH REDDY**(Roll No: **208522538052**), **GARAKU VAMSHI** (Roll No: **208522538053**) as a part of their curriculum in the Department of Commerce (Business Analytics), Avinash Degree College, Kukatpally, Hyderabad-500072. This work has been carried out under my guidance.

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Telangana 500072

Date:

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Project Guide

DECLARATION

Date:

I, GAJAWADA BALA SHIVA SAI TEJA(Reg.No.2085-22-538-049) along with **GANAPURAM ROHA TEJOO, Roll No: 208522538050, GARLAPATI SAMPATH REDDY, Roll No: 208522538052, GARAKU VAMSHI, Roll No: 208522538053** hereby declare that the project entitled **‘AN COMPARATIVE STUDY ON CONSUMER PREFERENCES BETWEEN APOLLO & MEDPLUS’**, submitted to the Osmania University, in partial fulfilment of the requirements for the award of the Degree of Bachelor of Commerce is a bonafide record of original project work done by us during the period of December-2024 to March-2025 under the supervision and guidance of **Ch. Kavya** and it has not formed the basis for the award of any Degree, Diploma, Associateship, Fellowship or other similar title to any other candidate of any University.

Signature of the Candidate

DECLARATION

Date:

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Signature of the Candidate

DECLARATION

Date:

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Signature of the Candidate

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Date:

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Signature of the Candidate

ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

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This project is the end of my journey in obtaining my Commerce Degree. At the end of my project, it is a pleasant task to express my thanks to all those who contributed in many ways to the success of this study and made it an unforgettable experience for me.

I sincerely record my thanks to **Mr. AVINASH BRAHMADEVARA** the Chairman of Avinash College of Commerce-Degree, Kukatpally, and other members of the management committee for encouraging me to take up this UG program in this reputed Institution.

I am grateful to our Principal **Mrs. M.V.Phanimala** for providing us the opportunity and platform to work on the project and providing all the necessary facilities for the successful completion of this work.

I express my humble gratitude to Head of the Department **Mrs. B. Hari Priya** for guiding, supporting, and inspiring me during my project work.

I am happy to express my gratitude to my Project Guide **Mrs. Ch. Kavya**, parents (G.CHANDRA SHEKAR & G.NAGAJYOTHI), friends, respondents and the almighty.

GAJAWADA BALA SHIVA SAI TEJA

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GANAPURAM ROHA TEJOO

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GARLAPATI SAMPATH REDDY

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GARAKU VAMSHI

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ABSTRACT

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The healthcare sector plays a very important role in this modern world. As pharmaceutical industries focused on the development, distribution of medicines and healthcare products to treat diseases, which are rapidly expanded their services to reach the customer needs, particularly after/post Covid19. This study provided a comparative analysis of two leading pharmacies of India: Med plus and Apollo focusing on the business, services, and customer satisfaction.

The primary Aim of this study was to find out the best pharmaceuticals provider along with understanding the important factors that influenced consumer choice between Med plus and Apollo. The study took into consideration of “Descriptive research design” and “simple random sampling method”. The size of sample is 149 respondents. Using the Structured Questionnaires and secondary data, the questionnaire will include a mix of multiple-choice questions to measure consumer satisfaction, product preferences, and service quality. This formed a clear observation and understanding of what determined consumer choice, satisfaction and preferences between med plus & Apollo.

The study attempted to conclude that, Med plus was represented for its competitive pricing and discounts to attract customers, and Apollo pharmacy’s trustworthiness, high-quality of customer services made it preferred choice for many. It found that understanding consumer behavior was important to remain competitive in this world.

Keywords: *Consumer preferences, Customer satisfaction, Healthcare, Med plus & Apollo pharmacy’s, quality of services.*

CHAPTER I

INTRODUCTION

1.1 INTRODUCTION

In this present world, the healthcare plays a very important role in our lives. After the impact of covid 19 virus. People are showing much interest towards the many features of healthcare, access to quality medicines and related services are seen the most. The pharmaceutical retail sector in India has grown rapidly, with many companies for share of consumer attention. Among them, Med plus & Apollo Pharmacy which have become well-known names in the Indian market due to their many products and services provided. This research is interested in looking at consumers preferences when choosing between these two pharmacy chains.

Med plus pharmacy and Apollo Pharmacy have both entered into the Indian healthcare market and aimed to meet those customers as trusted providers. Med plus was founded in 2006 and got its height for low price structures and discounts. Apollo has trust, wider product range and better service provisions. These two brands help millions of customers to tie up with them. This comparative study tries to analyze the factors influencing consumer choices between Med plus and Apollo pharmacy & diagnosis. By gathering information through structured questionnaire and secondary data, the research will provide a complete understanding of the strengths and weakness of each brand from the consumer's point of view. Furthermore, the findings will provide trends in the pharmaceutical retail sector, offering valuable guidance for stakeholders in this field.

This research will focus on how customer's decisions are affected by variety of product, quality of services and loyalty systems. This will also assess the impact of digital platforms- how the websites and mobile applications of Med Plus and Apollo Pharmacy shaped the customer experience. It would help not only Med Plus and Apollo Pharmacy in improving their respective business strategies. By understanding the needs of their target audiences, both brands will be able to adapt their strategies in such a Manner that they are more customer-friendly, brand loyalty, increase their satisfaction and performance in this competitive world environment. Consumer preferences play a very important role in determining the market success of any business.

The main aim of this study is to clarify how Med Plus and Apollo Pharmacy's customers look at them, what influences their choices and how these understandings can help both brands develop their strategies to remain competitive. Understanding these preferences is important not only for the pharmacies themselves but also for interested parties in the healthcare and retail industries, as it provides information regarding the consumer preferences/ consumer behavior. By the help of this study, we can able know

how to increase customer satisfaction and how it would be helpful for the companies to easily survive in this competitive world.

1.2 OBJECTIVES OF THE STUDY

- To find out the best pharmaceuticals provider among the Med plus and Apollo.
- To find out whether there is a significant difference in consumer satisfaction in quality between Med Plus and Apollo.
- To identify the most important factors influencing consumer choice between Med plus & Apollo.
- To find out which is the best Online & Offline Service provider among Med Plus & Apollo.

1.3 HYPOTHESIS OF THE STUDY

1. **H0:** There is no significant difference in consumer satisfaction in quality between Med plus and Apollo.
2. **H1:** There is a significant difference in consumer satisfaction in quality between Med plus and Apollo.

1.4 NEED OF THIS STUDY

Med plus and Apollo are one of the large pharmacy chains in today's market, Consumer behavior and preferences play a very important role in understanding the Business Growth. This Study was chosen to understand the factors that influences consumers such as Price and Discounts, Availability and Variety of Products, Customer service quality, Delivery and Consumer location services, membership etc.as one of the important factors.

The goal is to identify the best pharmaceuticals provider and along with areas for improvement for both pharmacy chains. This would help us to know consumers preferences and benefits the retailer. This study will help to identify the strengths and weakness of Both med plus and Apollo in terms of satisfaction among customers.

1.5 SCOPE OF THE STUDY

This Study will focus on analysis and comparison of consumer preferences for two main pharmacies in India: Med plus and Apollo Pharmacy and Diagnosis. This study will aim to explore factors that influence customer preferences when it comes to selecting one pharmacy over the other. It aims to assess to level of satisfaction that customers expect from Med plus and Apollo.

1.6 RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

- **Research design:** - In this study the research design we used was a Descriptive research design in which it attempted to analyze and compare the consumer preferences between Med Plus and Apollo Pharmacy.
- **Sample size:** - The study we use 149 responses form general public.
- **Sampling method:** - In this study the sampling method used was simple random method.
- **Collection of Data:** - Data will be collected through Structured Questionnaire. The questionnaire will include a mix of multiple-choice questions to measure consumer satisfaction, product preferences, and service quality. This will form a clear observation and understanding of what determines the consumer choice in selecting between Med Plus and Apollo Pharmacy, which in the future can be beneficial in developing business strategy.

1.7 CHAPTERIZATION

Chapter I	Introduction
Chapter II	Review of Literature
Chapter III	Industry/ Company Profile
Chapter IV	Data Analysis & Interpretation
Chapter V	Findings, suggestions & conclusion

1.8 LIMITATIONS OF THE STUDY

- This study is only restricted to Med plus and Apollo users.
- This is conducted to only for a set of few Respondents.
- Restricted to the geographical locations of Hyderabad only.

CHAPTER II

REVIEW OF LITERATURE

2.1 REVIEW OF LITERATURE

1. **Abraham, J., Sick, B., Anderson, et.al (2011):** The factors which affect the health by taking medicines from the pharmacy. Mainly the reputation of the pharmacy and pharmacist in that store. The experts said that the decisions regarding from where the medical products been bought, and the pharmacist experience play a vital role. The patients are decision makers in this case, so they have to be with more consciousness while making decisions, factors affect like financial position and access to information. The survey is conducted from the 467 patients at 4 clinics at Minnesota. The advertisement and information provided by the company can also affect the consumer preference. The patients will be referred to the specific stores or physicians, this is one type to choose the store or clinic. Contractual and logistical factors also play a role, with respondents highlighting the importance of seeing a provider affiliated with their health plan and appointment availability. The publishing of information through the social media channels like you tube, Instagram, Facebook, twitter can influence the reputation of the services.

2. **Chiara Whichello (2020):** This review explores the challenges and methods for insighting patient preferences into the medical product lifecycle (MPLC) and evaluates ways to measure these preferences effectively. Understanding patient preferences is essential for the success of medical products, yet there are significant barriers to incorporation these preferences into the development process. The Study found that while no single method is universally accepted as the gold standard, the Discrete choice experiment (DCE) shows great promise. Challenges such as inconsistent methodologies and lack of standardization continue to make integration difficult. Despite this, DCE stands out as a valuable tool for capturing patient preferences and helping decision makers understand tradeoffs. The findings highlight the importance of addressing these systematic challenges to align predict development more closely with patient needs. while perfect method remains elusive DCE offers practical and reliable features that could pave the way for more patient centered decision making in MPLC.

3. Dimoula M., Fotiadis, et.al (2018): To ascertain the criteria to purchase the pharmaceutical products and to get an objective picture on consumer behaviour. The methods used in this research are 1)the Questionnaires filled by pharmacy customers in capitals.2)sampling during normal course of business. The research is conducted on data of 3 European nations i.e.Greece,France,Bulgaria.The research is conducted in the capital of each nation which aim to fit the criteria motivating the patient/customer to purchase particular pharmaceutical products. Final aim is to get an objective pocture of purchasing behavior Greek,French,and Bulgaria countries. The factors affect the buying behaviour is cost, advertising, scientist's health condition and the other available sources. Individuality mainly results from the different levels of education and basic income of each pharmaceutical products consumer. There is I lack of ability to talk personally to the persons who gave the response to the survey in order to get the first-hand view on "pharmaceutical buying behaviour". There was no other similar research done by other nations as comparison among France-Greece-Bulgaria pharmaceutical products and the behaviour of purchasing methods by consumers in their respective nation.

4. Dr.P.Dolly Diana, R.Ushir,(2022): Consumer Perceptions of Online and Offline Pharmacies in Mumbai The study explores the mature preference for online pharmaceutics over offline single due to appliance. As digital platform gather popularity, concerns about fraudulent practices and uncomplete information in online chemist's have surfaced. The research, conducted in Mumbai, look into consumer perception of both case of pharmacies and examines the potential risks of purchasing medicament online. Using a qualitative approach and a nonchalant inquiry scheme, the report highlights key drift and challenges. Determination signals a significant consumer shift to online pharmaceutics, driven by the ease of access and fourth dimension - saving advantages. All The Same, the comportment of double-dealing practices, such as displaying inaccurate or insufficient information about medicines, raise safe concerns. The study punctuate the importance of addressing these payoff to ensure consumer trust and rubber. The research objectives were to sympathise consumer ruling and key dangers associated with on-line and offline pharmacy usage. In ending, while on-line pharmacies propose convenience, regulative measures and transparency.

- 5. Jayasuriyaa R, K.C. Raja Shree (2020):** The main reason of this research is to see what factors influence people's choices when selecting a hospital. The results showed that hospital preference, timing preference, and treatment preference are the main factors. However, there is no significant difference between these factors. The researchers collected data from (108) patients and analyzed it using (SPSS) statistical tools, results tells the majority of respondents were female and of age majority were less than 25. Studies have shown that patients feel they are the primary managers of their healthcare. Healthcare providers need to help patients manage their health and make informed decisions. The internet is used for health information and health related decision making. This study can help healthcare providers understand what patients want and needs. By knowing what factors influence hospital choice, healthcare providers can improve their services and attract more patients.
- 6. Katarina Bostrom (2011):** The study examines the factors that impact customer behavior in the choice of pharmacy gathering and OTC medicine purchases. It indicates that voucher is the most important element in the consumer making a decision to go to a pharmacy where the limits follow with the product range being the second most important and then last is the quality of the staff. Pharmacists' recommendations are the main factor in the purchase of OTC drugs, and buyers usually get professional help to make their purchasing decisions. Furthermore, the views of family and friends are the other important things in the selection of OTC medicines. The study underscores the significant reasons namely, accessibility, a variety of products, and customer service in selecting a pharmacy on the one hand and as for OTC medicines the results point to the pharmacist's advice and word of mouth from close friends as the most important ones. A quantitative research was conducted by the use of questionnaires, with 273 people taking part in the survey, and the complete procedure was accomplished at four different pharmacies. These findings have enormous effects on the strategic plans of pharmacies that target the enhancement of customer satisfaction and loyalty.

7. KeertiJain, Priyankasharma, et.al (2017): The research explores the demographics such as gender, occupation, income and age in relation to the consumption of pharmaceutical drugs in the NCR region of India. It notes that antibiotics and painkillers are the most abused substances by most people in different population groups. The findings of the research demonstrate that younger people abuse drugs more than older people . . The goal of the research was achieved through the use of primary data from questionnaire surveys conducted in the NCR zone which offered a detailed perspective on the consumption patterns of the zone. The analysis of the data was done by the aid of R programming as this gave good statistical information of the impact of the above factors on the use of pharmaceuticals. It results in Antibiotics and analgesics are most frequently used drugs. Age group significantly affects drug consumption behavior. It concludes Antibiotics and analgesics are most frequently consumed drugs.

8. Ketelaar, N. a. B. M., Faber, et.al (2014): The objective of the study is to know the value of the customers and the information gathered from them. Get clarity information about the comparative performance. There are 2 methods used in this research; they are 1)Qualitative research using 6 groups interviews. Thematic analysis of transcribed focus group data. The publication of Comparative Performance Information(CPI).The research is oriented towards the comparative performance index(CPI)and the extent the consumer gives the value towards it. Twenty-seven healthcare consumers were recruited using a mailing list and by personal invitation. Finding is most of the participants not known about comparative performance information (CPI) and focused on other sources of information is marginally valued due to conflicting values expressed by the customers, it does not provide a useful information to choose the best hospital. The upcoming projects to be concentrate on values of consumers and their impact on the use of CPI.

9. Li kai (2013): This study examined how consumer heterogeneous preference affect the bargaining power of retailers, and also found that when consumers have strong preferences for a particular retailer that retailer get more negotiation power. In other words. The retailers will have an upper hand in negotiation. This research also showed that as consumer preferences for a retailer increases, the retailers bargaining power. This in turn, can benefit consumer and society. Retailers with strong bargaining power may be able to negotiate better prices for goods, which can lead to lower price for consumers and also by this more people have access to affordable goods. The idea proposed by Galbraith he said that big retailer's power can be matched by consumers power, means that consumers can have just as much influence as large retailers. This research has implications for retailers, consumers and policymakers. For retailers it shows the importance of building strong relationships with consumers. For consumers it suggests that their preferences can have an impact on the market overall. the study provides a detailed understanding of the complex relationships between consumers, retailers and bargaining power.

10.Nikalas Rudholm, David Granlund, (2012): This study looks at consumer opposition to pharmaceutical substitution and the role of prescribing doctors in consumer choices. It finds that consumers are more opposed to substitution when the original product is a brand or secondary brand, with brand products facing 2.5 times more opposition than generics. Consumers don't always go for the cheapest option and can switch to substitute products that aren't the lowest priced. Women are more opposed to substitution than men. The research shows consumers are more opposed to brands than generics, brand loyalty and trust in established products are key. Prescribing doctors play a big role in shaping consumer decisions And doctor recommendations can reduce resistance to switching. This study contributes to the understanding of substitution behavior in the pharmaceutical market and has implications for policymakers, healthcare providers and pharmaceutical companies.

11.Pavithira, S. Subathira, R., et.al (2015): The objective is to know the customer satisfaction of customers of Apollo pharmacy. Where to know the level of contentment from the customers, author gathered the data from the consumers residing at Ambattpur,Chennai. Most of the people at Ambattpur have the positive response to the medicines provided by the Apollo pharmaceuticals. The method of the research is Descriptive research. The sample size of the research is 50 i.e. customers of Ambattpur area.90% of customers recommend others to purchase the medicines from the Apollo pharmacy only. The pharmacy provides all types of medicines like surgical medicines,non surgical medicines,vitamins and mineral supplements, and those are having from various brands. The interesting finding from the research is the factors like age, occupation, gender are not playing the role in factors affecting the level of satisfaction by patients. The people in that area or surroundings have the trust towards the products as well as the services provided by the pharmacy employees.

12.Stefanie Gandt (2022): This article explores what customers want when they visit a store. The author studied shoppers like LLC SINAP and came up with practical tips to improve the company's marketing strategy. To succeed in business, we need to understand what makes customers tick. Means studying them in detail to figure out what they like and dislike. The study revealed that what influences customers buying decisions and what they look for in a store. The study also found out how happy customers are with their shopping experience and what business can do to keep them loyal. And also created a picture of what a typical customer look like. This study help SINAP improve it's marketing strategy, and explored how important customers are and what they need from a marketing perspective. And also, of consumers preferences what customers like and dislike about shopping at Yabloko supermarkets. The study found out what makes them decide to buy something and what they look for in a store. The survey help to understand how satisfied customers are, how to keep them loyal and what the company can improve.

13. Tony P Jose, Suraj Kushe Shekhar, et.al (2019): The research shows that consumers actively seek information before buying or consuming medicines and often turn to the internet for guidance. Trust in the product and brand also plays a big role in decision making with consumers preferring over the counter drugs because of perceived safety and accessibility. The main objective is consumer behavior and attitudes towards buying pharmaceuticals and what influences the decision making. It highlights the importance of factors like price, trust, and brand in purchase decisions. The finding suggests that pharmaceutical companies need to consider pricing strategies, trust building and clear information dissemination to be in line with consumer preferences. Overall, the paper provides insights into how consumers buy pharmaceuticals and that price, trust and information are the key drivers of buying decisions. Consumers resort to internet for information before consuming medicine. Price sensitivity dominates consumer buying behavior.

14. Yoong Jun Han (2019): This study looks at how preference reversal affects the way people choose between products, focusing on medical services and general products. Preference reversal happens when the importance of product attributes shifts, causing people to change their selection. The researchers aimed to understand two key things: How product characteristics and situations influence preference reversal. How consumer preferences affect their actual choices. To explore this, they used multiple logistic regression analysis on categorical data. This method helped uncover the relationship between preference reversals and selection changes across different product categories. The findings revealed that preference reversal influences choices in both medical and general products. However, medical services showed higher sensitivity to attribute changes than general products. For example, people might reconsider their choice of a medical service if certain features, like safety or cost, are emphasized differently. These selection changes were found to be more pronounced in medical services because their attributes often carry greater weight in decision-making. In summary, the study highlights that the way we prioritize product attributes plays a big role in what we end up choosing, especially in critical areas like medical services.

15. Young Yoon Ji (2020): This study explores how consumers react to hospital marketing natural action, pore on both insurance and non - insurance trend. It aimed to understand what drives their acceptance and how functional and emotional values shape their behavior. We habituate the Technical Acceptance Model (TAM) and a geomorphologic model to canvas consumer demeanor. Key divisor like public toilet, usefulness, and satisfaction were examined. The determination demonstrate that people prefer net selling for non - insurance courses. For indemnity class, convenience mattered more than utility in tempt acceptance. Useable and emotional note value act a giving character in regulate confident consumer attitude. Quenched client was to a greater extent likely to engage and commend the serve. Additionally, online word - of - mouth boosted communication and encourage repeat sojourn. This spotlight the power of customer feedback in aim repurchase intention. In conclusion, consumer palpate more at easiness with selling for non - insurance path. For indemnity - concern offering, convenience is a stronger motivator for acceptance.

CHAPTER III

COMPANY PROFILE



3.1 INTRODUCTION:

Med Plus was founded in 2006 by Gangadi Madhukar Reddy, Founder, Managing Director and Chief Executive Officer, with the vision to set up a trusted pharmacy retail brand that offers genuine medicines and delivers better value to the customer by reducing inefficiencies in the supply chain using technology. Mr. Gangadi, both a doctor and an entrepreneur, plays an instrumental role in the strategic direction and growth of our business.

Company operate 4,230+ stores in 600+ cities distributed across 10 states: Tamil Nadu, Andhra Pradesh, Telangana, Karnataka, Odisha, West Bengal, Maharashtra, Kerala, Chhattisgarh and Madhya Pradesh. We have a total of 22,000+ permanent full-time in-house employees working for us in a range of business activities. (all details as of February 05th 2024)

operations include retail and wholesale sale, manufacturing and contract manufacturing of private label pharmaceutical, wellness and FMCG products, import, distribution, and full-fledged diagnostic centres.

Vision & Mission

To become a leading provider of healthcare products and services by ensuring customer trust and satisfaction.

To deliver high-quality healthcare products at affordable prices with exceptional service.

3.2 STRATEGIES OF MED PLUS

Strengthen Market Position by Increasing Store Penetration across existing and new clusters Further develop Our Omni-channel Platform with a Hyperlocal Delivery Model. Enhance Revenue and Increase Customer Wallet Share through continued investment in technology infrastructure and expansion into adjacent healthcare vertical Increase Operating Efficiency and Enhance Supply Chain Management to drive profitability.& To increase the sales.

3.3 LEADERSHIP

Mr. Madhukar Gangadi : Managing Director, Chief Executive Officer

Mr. Bhaskar Reddy Cherukupalli: Chief Operating Officer

3.3.1 BOARD OF DIRECTOR

- 1.Mr. Gangadi Madhukar Reddy: Chairman, Managing Director and Chief Executive Officer
- 2.Ms. Aparna Surabhi: Non-Executive Independent Director
- 3.Mr. Madhavan Ganesan: Non-Executive Independent Director
3. Mr. Murali Sivaraman: Non-Executive Independent Director
- 4.Mr. Cherukupalli Bhaskar Reddy: Whole Time Director

3.4 MANAGEMENT

- 1.Mr. Gangadi Madhukar Reddy: Chairman, Managing Director and Chief Executive Officer
- 2.Mr. Cherukupalli Bhaskar Reddy: Chief Operating Officer and Whole–Time Director
- 3.Mr. Sujit Kumar Mahato: Chief Financial Officer
- 4.Mr. Chetan Dikshit: Chief Strategy Officer
- 5.Mr. Lakshman Kandarpa: Chief Retail Officer

6.Mr. Kandasamy: Head of Supply Chain

7.Mr. Venugopal Siripuram: Chief Technology Officer

8.Mr. Manoj Kumar Srivastava: Head - Corporate Secretarial, Company Secretary & Compliance Officer.

3.5 Med plus services is guided by three themes: Quality, Convenience, and Value - "Our Competitive Strengths".

- **Value Pricing.** Reduce inefficiencies in the supply chain using technology to deliver better value to the customers. We deliver more value to customer in the form of discounts that have increased from up to 10% to up to 20% of the maximum retail price. We cater to a wide range of customers, including discount seekers, customers with urgent needs and customers who value convenience.
- **Convenience and Fulfilment.** We focus on offering convenience to our customers by making a wide range of products available across our offline and online channels. Our customers can either visit our extensive network of stores, or access our offerings online, through our website and mobile application, with the option of either picking up products at the store or having it delivered to them. We believe that we have been able to develop a better understanding of our customers' requirements through (i) years of operational experience, (ii) active customer engagement, and (iii) real time data analytics platform. This has allowed us to stock the appropriate selection and target high fill rates.
- **2-hour delivery capability.** With our wholly-managed and operated last-mile delivery infrastructure from our stores, we were able to deliver our customers' online purchases within two hours of purchase, in select cities. These services were started in the financial year 2021, and recent pilots conducted in July, 2021, have showed promising results where 93% of online delivery purchases were delivered within two hours in select micro-markets of Hyderabad.
- **Engagement.** Our stores present a consistent and uniform customer experience of offering genuine and good quality pharmaceutical products and fast-moving consumer goods at affordable prices. Our stores are operated by trained staff, who are aided by our real time data customer analysis and data, that we believe results in high levels of customer engagement.

Med Plus Pharmacy has a history and track record of over 15 years, and we believe that it has become a well-established brand that we have positioned to stand for genuine and good quality pharmaceutical products that are offered at affordable prices.



3.6 Med Plus Mart :-

Customers could either visit our stores or access our offerings online, through our website and mobile application. Our customers have multiple options.

1. Purchasing products at one of our stores.
2. Placing an order through a telephone call to receive delivery of their purchased products.
3. Placing an order online to receive delivery of their purchased products.
4. "Click and Pick", by placing an order online and picking up their purchased products from one of our stores. Our "Click and Pick" proposition allows our customers the ease of showing their prescription at a store, in cases where uploading the prescription online becomes a challenge. With our wholly-managed and operated last-mile delivery infrastructure from our stores, we are now able to deliver our customers' online purchases within two hours of purchase in select cities of Hyderabad, Bangalore, Kolkata, Pune and Nagpur.

3.7 REVENUE

Revenue from operations.

Year	Mar-22	Mar-23	Mar-24
Revenue From Operations [Gross]	136.07	202.38	455.16

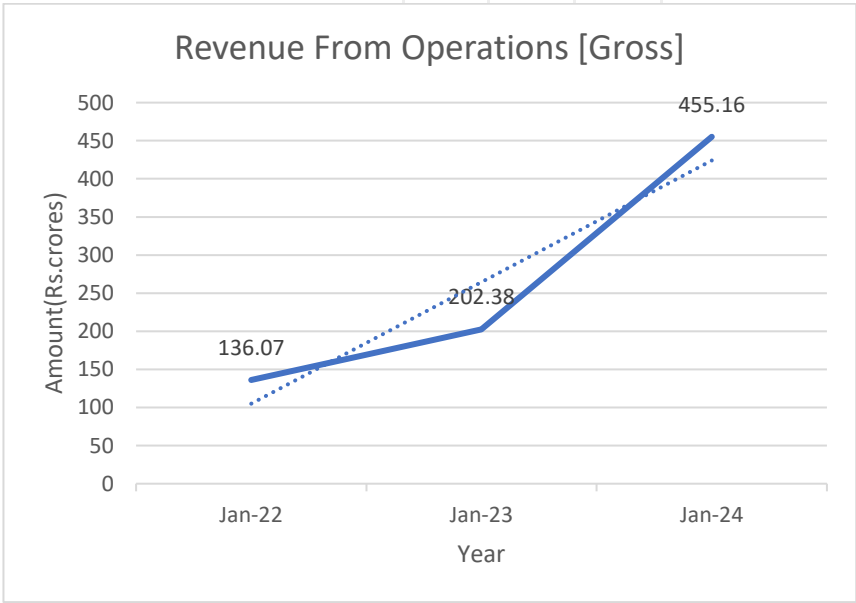


Figure:3.7 Revenue over past 3 years.

Source:<https://www.moneycontrol.com/financials/medplushealthservices/profit-lossVI/mhs01>

3.8 TOTAL EXPENSES

Year	Mar-22	Mar-23	Mar-24
Total Expenses	149.68	222.58	149.68

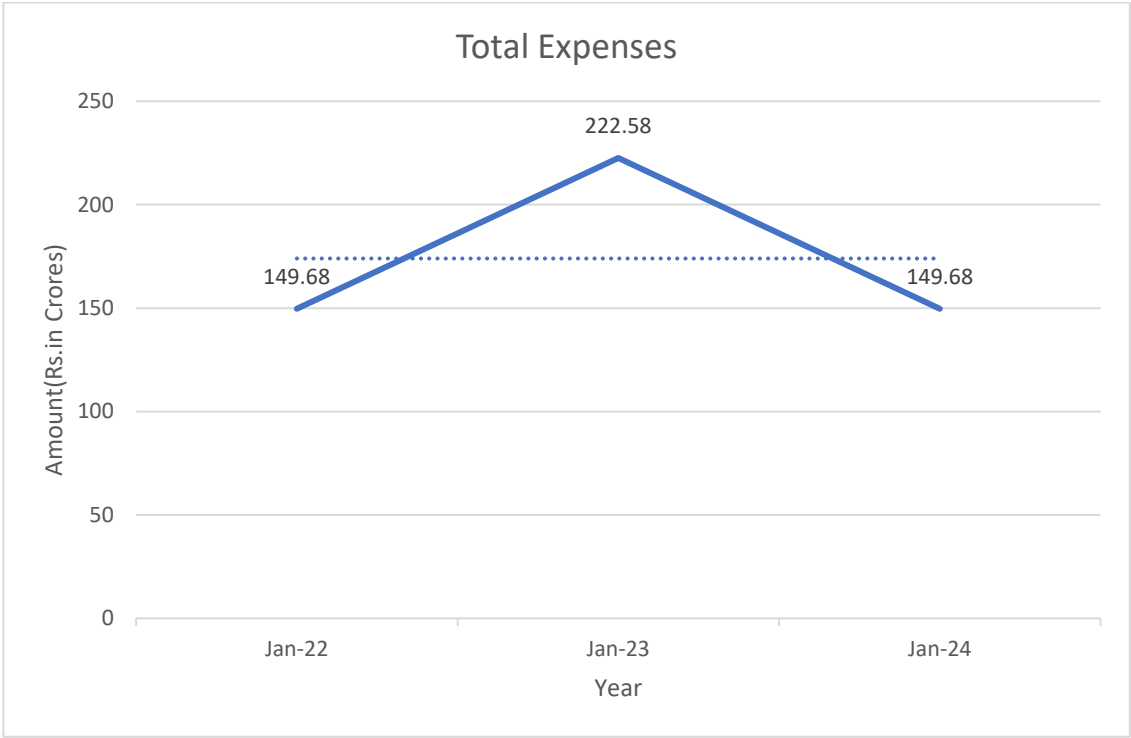


Figure : 3.8 Total Expenses over 3 years.

Source:<https://www.moneycontrol.com/financials/medplushealthservices/profit-lossVI/mhs01>

3.9 BRANCHES OF MED PLUS

- 1.Telangana
- 2.Maharashtra
- 3.Andhra Pradesh
- 4.Karnataka
- 5.Tamilnadu
- 6.West Bengal
- 7.Delhi
- 8.Madhya Pradesh
- 9.Odisha
- 10.Chattisgarh



3.10 INTRODUCTION

Apollo Hospitals was established in 1983 by Dr. Prathap C Reddy, renowned as the architect of modern healthcare in India. As the nation's first corporate hospital, Apollo Hospitals is acclaimed for pioneering the private healthcare revolution in the country.

Apollo Hospitals has emerged as Asia's foremost integrated healthcare services provider and has a robust presence across the healthcare ecosystem, including Hospitals, Pharmacies, Primary Care & Diagnostic Clinics and several retail health models. The Group also has Telemedicine facilities across several countries, Health Insurance Services, Global Projects Consultancy, Medical Colleges, Medvarsity for E-Learning, Colleges of Nursing and Hospital Management and a Research Foundation. In addition, 'ASK Apollo' – an online consultation portal and Apollo Home Health provide the care continuum.

The cornerstones of Apollo's legacy are its unstinting focus on clinical excellence, affordable costs, modern technology and forward-looking research & academics. Apollo Hospitals was among the first few hospitals in the world to leverage technology to facilitate seamless healthcare delivery. The organization embraced the rapid advancement in medical equipments across the world, and pioneered the introduction of several cutting edge innovations in India. Recently, South East Asia's first Proton Therapy Centre commenced operations at the Apollo Centre in Chennai.

Since its inception, Apollo Hospitals has been honoured by the trust of over 150 million individuals who came from 140 countries. At the core of Apollo's patient-centric culture is TLC (Tender Loving Care), the magic that inspires hope amongst its patients.

Dr. Prathap C Reddy, Founder Chairman of the Apollo Hospitals Group has been conferred with the prestigious Padma Vibhushan, India's second highest civilian award.

Vision & Mission

Apollo's vision for the next phase of development is to 'Touch a Billion Lives'.

"Our mission is to bring healthcare of International standards within the reach of every individual. We are committed to the achievement and maintenance of excellence in education, research and healthcare for the benefit of humanity"

3.11 STRATEGIES OF APOLLO

Apollo Pharmacy employs a multi-faceted strategy to maintain its leadership in the retail pharmacy sector. It focuses on expanding its footprint across India, integrating online and offline channels through its Apollo 24|7 platform, and offering a wide range of products, including prescription medicines, wellness items, and in-house brands. Customer-centric initiatives like loyalty programs, 24/7 service, and affordable pricing ensure accessibility and trust. Leveraging technology, Apollo optimizes inventory, enhances customer experiences, and drives operational efficiency.

3.12 Management

3.12.1 Executive Directors

1. Dr. Prathap C. Reddy : Founder, Chairman
2. Dr. Preetha Reddy: Executive Vice Chairperson, Apollo Hospitals Enterprise Limited.
3. Ms. Shobana Kamineni: Promoter Director, Apollo Hospitals Enterprise Limited
Executive Chairperson, Apollo Health Co Ltd and Apollo Pharmacies Ltd
4. Dr. Suneeta Reddy: Managing Director
5. Dr. Sangita Reddy: Joint Managing Director

3.12.2 Independent Directors

1.Dr. Murali Doraiswamy

2.Ms. V. Kavitha Dutt

3.Mr. MBN Rao

4.Mr. Som Mittal

5.Ms. Rama Bijapurkar

3.13 AWARDS AND ACCOLADES

Indian Digital Marketing Awards	Year
Apollo eDoc website wins the bronze medal for best SEO website at Indian Digital Marketing Awards, 2016.	2016

Website of the year India Award	Year
Apollo Hospitals has won the award for Most Popular Website in the Health category at the Website of the year India Awards 2014.	2014

Asian Leadership Awards	Year
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Apollo Hospitals (Group) – “Emergency 24×7” Mobile App won the Best Branded Mobile App Award at the Asian Leadership Awards.	2014
Apollo Hospitals (Group) Website won the Best Website Award at the Asian Leadership Awards.	2014

Best Social Community Award	Year
Apollo Hospitals (Group) – “Blood Connections” won the Best Social Community Award at the Social Media for Empowerment Awards.	2014

The Consumer Engagement Asia Awards	Year
Apollo Hospitals (Group) – “Blood Connections” won the Gold at the Consumer Engagement Asia Awards.	2014
Apollo Hospitals (Group) – ” Emergency 24×7 ” won the Gold at the Consumer Engagement Asia Awards.	2014

Apollo Hospitals (Group) – “360 Degree Approach ” won the Bronze at the Consumer Engagement Asia Awards.	2014
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Best Healthcare Provider Website	Year
Apollo Hospitals Group Website won the “Best Healthcare Provider Website” Award in the Internet Advertising Competition – IAC 2011 by the Web Marketing Association, USA.	2011

Hospital Management Asia Award	Year
Apollo Hospitals bags the award for the Marketing, PR or Online Presence category at the Asian Hospital Management Awards	2016
Apollo Hospitals (Group) – “Let’s Talk Health – 360 Degree Approach on Social Media” won the Hospital Management Asia Award under the Marketing, PR or Online Presence category.	2014

Apollo Hospitals (Group) – “Blood Connections” won the Hospital Management Asia Award under the Customer Service category.	2014
Apollo Hospitals (Group) – “Emergency 24×7” Mobile App won the Hospital Management Asia Award under the Innovations in Healthcare IT category.	2014

Manthan South West India Award	Year
Apollo Hospitals, Emergency 24×7 – “Special Mention Award” in the e-Health category by the Manthan South West India Award.	2014

Award by the International Advertising Competition	Year
Apollo Hospitals, Emergency 24×7 – “Best Health Care Mobile Application” Award by the International Advertising Competition – IAC 2014 by the Web Marketing Association, USA.	2014

WOTY	Year
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WOTY India 2013 awarded Apollo Hospitals the ‘Most Popular Website’ of the year for the category ‘Health and Well being’.	2013
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Web Award	Year
Apollo Hospitals Group won the “Standard of Excellence” Web Award 2012 under the categories Health Care, Healthcare Provider and Medical Excellence.	2012

The businesses of AHL are: • Pharmacy Distribution supply (excluding Hospital Based Pharmacies); • Apollo 24/7 Digital healthcare Platform; • “Apollo 24/7 brand, the “Apollo Pharmacy” brand and private label brands

Revenue and EBITDA for AHL for FY23 is INR 67,045 Mn and negative INR 1,249 Mn respectively based on the audited financial statements shared by the Management. Further, Revenue and EBITDA for AHL for the 9 months period ending 31 December 2023 is INR 58,001 Mn and negative INR 934 Mn respectively based on the provisional financial statements shared by the Management. AHL also holds an investment of 25.5% in Apollo Medicals Private Limited (“AMPL”) which further holds 100 % stake in both Apollo Pharmacies Limited (“APL”) and Apollo Pharmalogistics Private Limited (“APPL”). • APL manages the frontend offline and online pharmacy retailing. It has 5000+ offline stores across all locations over India. APL buys the inventory from AHL and pays a brand license fees to AHL for the brand “ Apollo Pharmacy”. • APPL provides online pharmacy logistics support services to APL. Revenue and EBITDA for AMPL for FY23 is INR 82,588 Mn and INR 1,281 Mn respectively based on the audited financial statements shared by the Management. Further, Revenue and EBITDA for AMPL for the 9 months period ending 31 December 2023 is INR 73,305 Mn and INR 1,293 Mn respectively based on the provisional financial statements shared by the Management.

3.14 Sales turnover

Year	Mar '24	Mar '23	Mar '22	Mar '21	Mar '20
Sales Turnover(Crores)	7,273.80	6,524.80	6,098.30	9,153.00	9,794.40

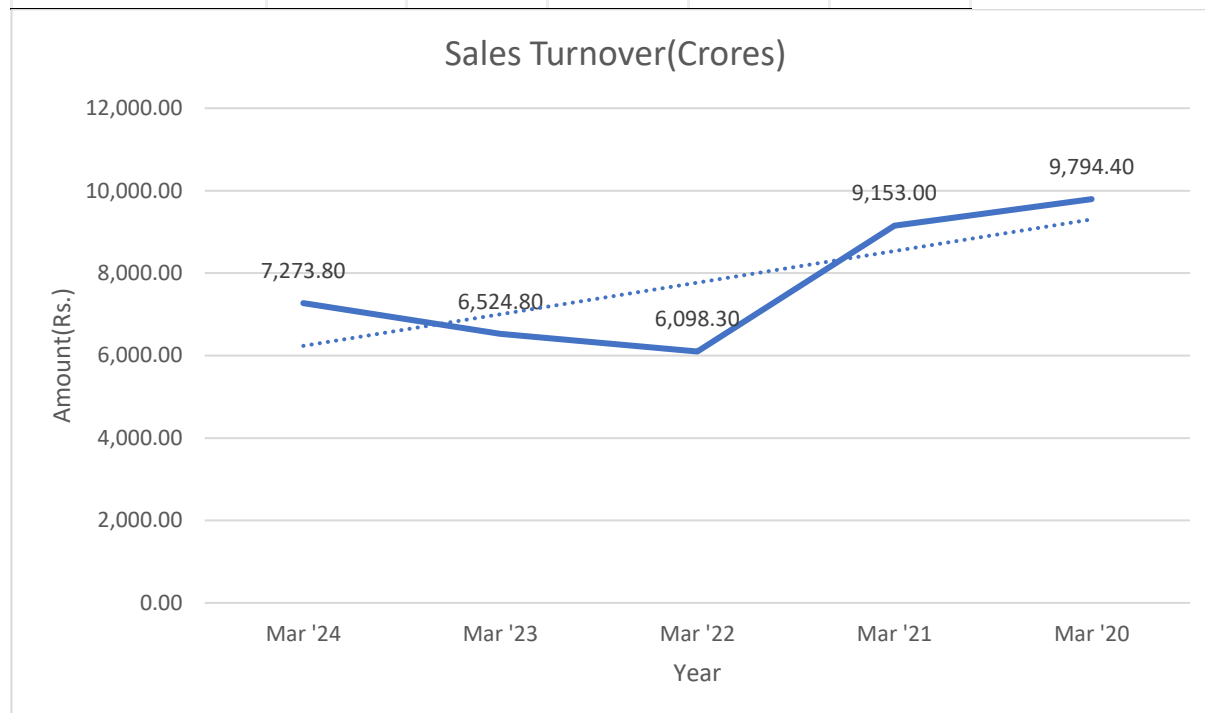


Figure : 3.14 Sales turnover over past five years.

Source: <https://www.moneycontrol.com/financials/apollohospitalenterprise/profit-lossVI/ahe>

3.15 OTHER INCOME

Year	Mar '24	Mar '23	Mar '22	Mar '21	Mar '20
Other Income	179.9	151.5	47.1	9	175.3

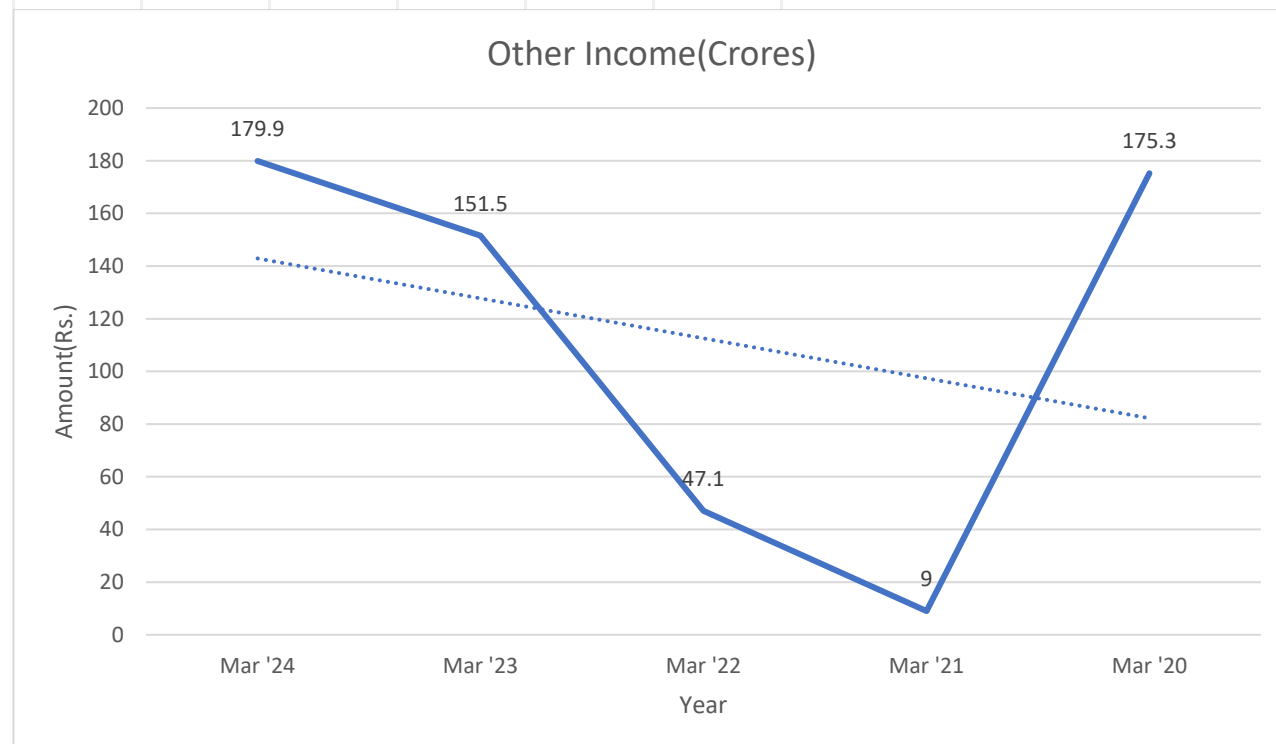


Figure: 3.15 Other income over past five years.

Source: <https://www.moneycontrol.com/financials/apollohospitalsenterprises/profit-lossVI/ahe>

3.16 TOTAL EXPENSES

Year	Mar '24	Mar '23	Mar '22	Mar '21	Mar '20
Total Expenses	5,476.30	4,843.30	4,678.90	8,333.30	8,483.40

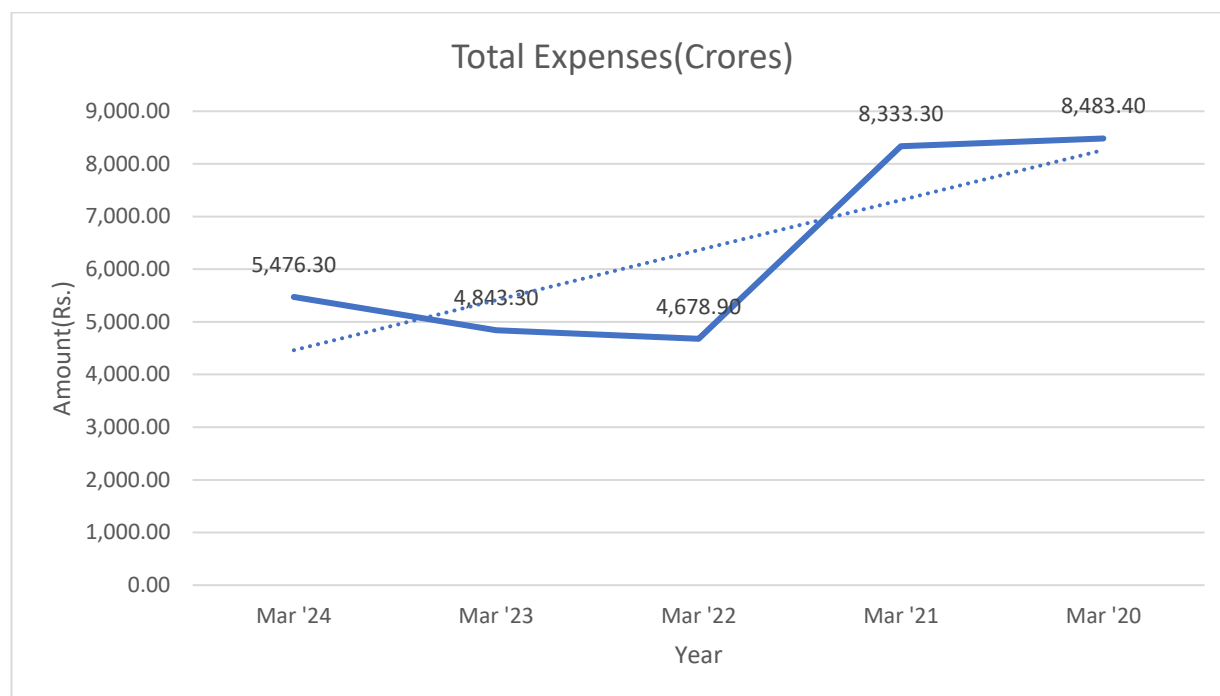


Figure: 3.16 Total expenses over past five years.

Sources: <https://www.moneycontrol.com/financials/apollohospitalsenterprises/profit-lossVI/ahe>

3.17 Specialties And Super Specialties

Apollo Hospitals has dedicated Centers of Excellence for several key specialties and super specialties. They are unique and state-of-the-art facilities spread across several of the Apollo hospital location and each Centre of Excellence stands out as a citadel of excellence.

- 1.Heart
- 2.Orthopedics

- 3.Spine
- 4.Neurosciences
- 5.Gastroenterology
- 6.Cancer
- 7.Transplant
- 8.ICU
- 9.Emergency
- 10.Preventive medicine
- 11.Robotics
- 12.Bariatric surgery
- 13.Nephrology and Urology
- 14.Colorectal surgery
- 15.Obstetrics and Gynaecology
- 16.Pulmonology
17. ENT(Otolaryngology)
- 18.Vascular surgery
- 19.Pediatrics
- 19.Dermatology
- 20.Critical care
- 21.Genomic Medicine
- 22.Podiatric Surgery

3.18 BRANCHES OF APOLLO

- 1.Ahmedabad
- 2.Aragonda
- 3.Banglore
- 4.Bhuvaneshwar
- 5.Bilsapur
- 6.Bhopal
- 7.Chennai
- 8.Delhi
- 9.Gawhati
- 10.Hyderabad
- 11.Indore
- 12.Kakinada
- 13.Karur
- 14.Kochi
- 15.Kolkata
- 16.Lucknow
- 17.Madurai
- 18.Mysore
- 19.Nashik
- 20.Nellore
- 21.Noida.

CHAPTER IV

DATA ANALYSIS & INTERPRETATION

4.1 Consumers Preferences between Med plus and Apollo.

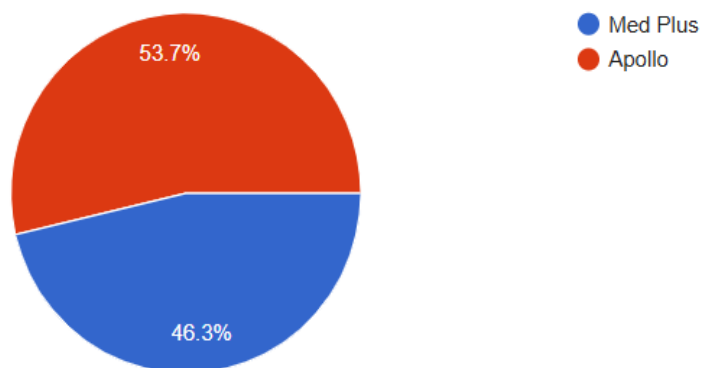
Table 4.1 Consumer Preferences

Particular	Frequency	Percentage
Med Plus	69	46.3%
Apollo	80	53.7%
Total	149	100%

Source: Primary Data.

Chart 4.1 (c) Consumer Preferences

149 responses



INTERPRETATION:

According to the Table & Chart it shows us that Apollo has slightly higher of customer Preferences (53.7%) compared to Med plus (46.3%). This will indicate us that Apollo is Holding an higher customer preferences.

4.2 Age Profile Overview Based on the Responses

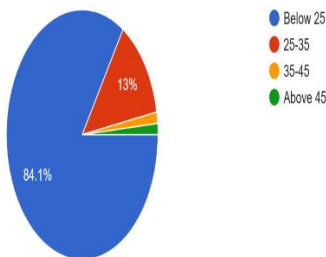
Table 4.2 Age group overview of Med plus and Apollo.

Particular	Med plus(a)		Apollo(b)	
	Frequency	Percentage	Frequency	Percentage
Below 25	58	84.1%	70	87.5%
25-35	9	13.0%	6	7.5%
35-45	1	1.4%	4	5%
Above 45	1	1.4%	0	0%
Total	69	100%	80	100%

Source: Primary Data.

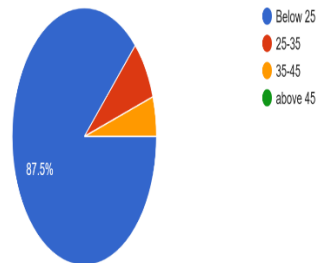
Chart 4.2 (c) Age group overview

Age
69 responses



(a)

Age
80 responses



(b)

INTERPRETATION OF MED PLUS AND APOLLO : The majority of customers for both Med Plus (84.1%) and Apollo (87.5%) are below 25 years old, indicating a strong preference among younger individuals. The least represented group is those above 45 years old, with only 1.4% in Med Plus and none in Apollo.

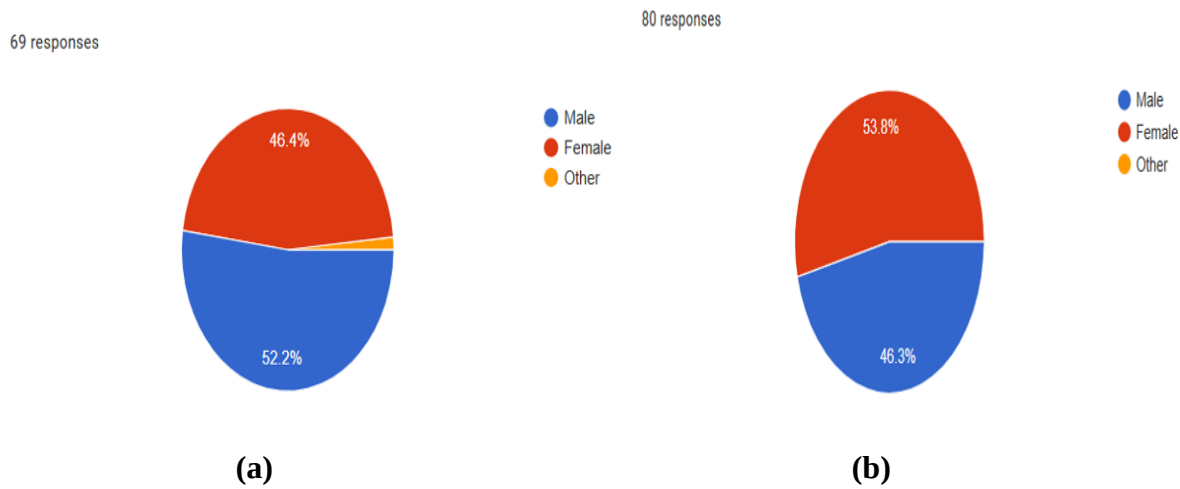
4.3 Gender Distribution Overview Based on the Responses

Table 4.3 Gender Overview of Med plus and Apollo.

Particular	Med plus(a)		Apollo(b)	
	Frequency	Percentage	Frequency	Percentage
Male	36	52.2%	37	46.3%
Female	32	46.4%	43	53.8%
Other	1	1.4%	0	0%
Total	69	100%	80	100%

Source: Primary Data

Chart 4.3(c) Gender overview.



Interpretation of Med plus & Apollo:

According to the table , the Majority of customers for med plus is males(52.2%) and for Apollo (53.8%) of females. The least represented group is the “other” Category, with only 1.4% in Med plus and none in Apollo.

4.4 Overview of Educational Qualifications of Responders

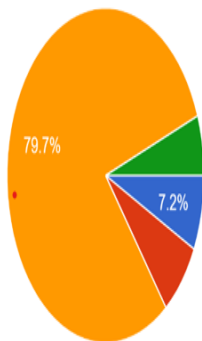
Table 4.4 Educational qualifications of Responders.

Particular	Med plus(a)		Apollo(b)	
	Frequency	Percentage	Frequency	Percentage
10 th	5	7.2%	2	2.5%
Intermediate	5	7.2%	9	11.3%
Degree	55	79.7%	59	73.8%
Post Graduation	4	6%	10	13%
Total	69	100%	80	100%

Source: Primary Data.

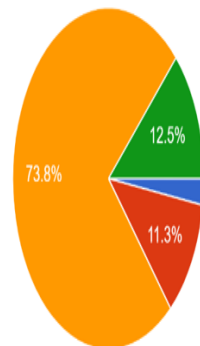
Chart 4.4(c) Educational qualifications of Responders.

Education Qualification
69 responses



(a)

Education Qualification
80 responses



(b)

Interpretation of Med plus & Apollo :

From the Above Table, 79.7% of respondents are from Med plus & 73.8% of respondents from Apollo are having Degree qualification as the majority. And the least represented category is 10th Qualification, with only 7.2% in Med Plus and 2.5% in Apollo.

4.5 Occupation Distribution Insights Based on the Responses.

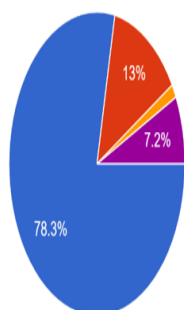
Table 4.5 Occupation Overview

Particular	Med plus(a)		Apollo(b)	
	Frequency	Percentage	Frequency	Percentage
Students	54	78.3%	67	83.8%
private Employee	9	13.1%	8	10.0%
Government Employee	1	1.4%	0	0.0%
Un employee	0	0%	1	1%
Self Business	5	7.2%	4	5%
Total	69	100%	80	100%

Source : Primary Data.

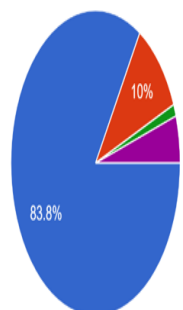
Chart 4.5 (c) Occupation Overview

Occupation
69 responses



(a)

Occupation
80 responses



(b)

Interpretation of Med Plus & Apollo :

For both Med plus and Apollo, the majority of respondents are students , with 78.3% in Med plus and 83.8% in Apollo, The Least category was Government employees with only 1.4% in Med plus and Unemployee as 1% in Apollo.

4.6 Satisfaction with Med Plus & Apollo Medicine Quality.

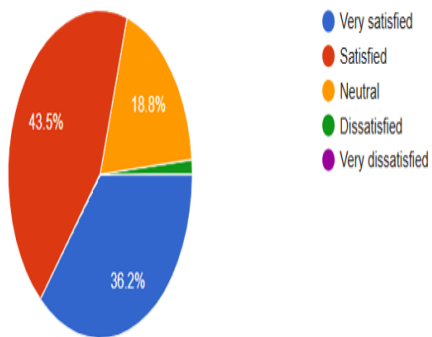
Table 4.6 Customer satisfaction on Med plus & Apollo.

Particular	Med plus(a)		Apollo(b)	
	Frequency	Percentage	Frequency	Percentage
Very Satisfied	25	36.23%	22	27.5%
Satisfied	30	43.48%	46	57.5%
Neutral	13	18.84%	11	13.8%
Dissatisfied	1	1.45%	0	0%
Very Dissatisfied	0	0.00%	1	1.2%
Total	69	100%	80	100%

Source : Primary Data.

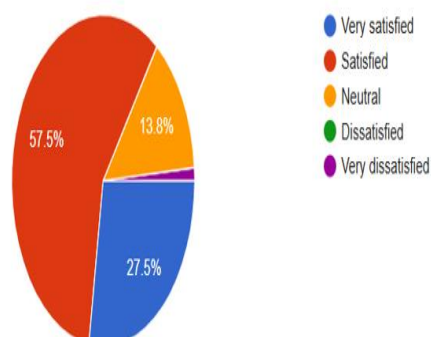
Chart 4.6(c) Consumer Satisfaction on Medicines.

69 responses



(a)

80 responses



(b)

Interpretation of Med plus & Apollo :

The majority of customers have a positive experience, with the highest percentage falling under "Satisfied" (43.48% for Med Plus and 57.5% for Apollo). The least common responses are negative experiences, with only 1.45% dissatisfied in Med Plus and 1.2% very dissatisfied in Apollo.

4.7 Rating the Availability of Medicines of Med plus and Apollo.

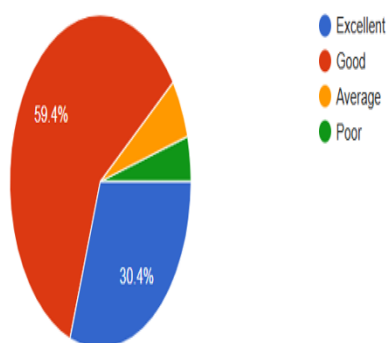
Table 4.7 Medicine Availability of Med plus & Apollo Rating

Particular	Med plus(a)		Apollo(b)	
	Frequency	Percentage	Frequency	percentage
Excellent	21	30.43	24	30
Good	41	59.42	49	61.3
Average	4	5.80	6	7.5
poor	3	4.35	1	1.2
Total	69	100	80	100

Source: Primary Data.

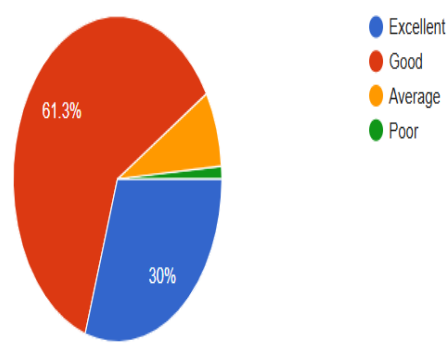
Chart 4.7(c) Medicine Availability : By Rating of Responders.

69 responses



(a)

80 responses



(b)

Interpretations of Med plus & Apollo:

From the above table, The majority rated medicine availability as Good for both Med plus (59.42%) and Apollo (61.3%), the least common rating was poor with only (4.35%) for Med plus and (1.2%) for Apollo. Showing very few of them faced issues with Medicine availability.

4.8 Evaluating Med plus & Apollo Customer Service Expectations.

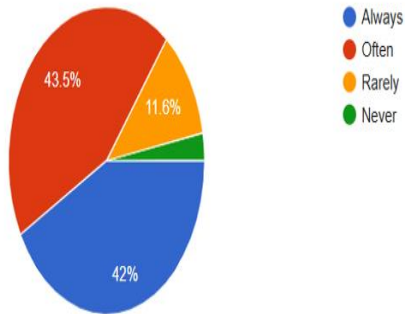
Table 4.8 Med Plus & Apollo Customer Service Expectation.

Particular	Med plus(a)		Apollo(b)	
	Frequency	Percentage	Frequency	Percentage
Always	29	42%	38	47.5%
Often	30	43.5%	35	43.8%
Rarely	8	11.6%	5	6.3%
Never	2	2.9%	2	2.5%
Total	69	100%	80	100%

Source: Primary Data.

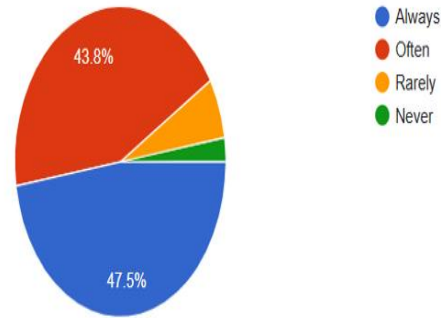
Chart 4.8(c) Customer service expectations.

69 responses



(a)

80 responses



(b)

Interpretation of Med plus & Apollo :

According to the Table, the Majority of respondents are having positive service expectations with Med plus(43.5%) and Apollo(47.5%) . The least common responses is Never with only 2.9% for Med plus and 2.5% for Apollo.

4.9 Competitiveness of Med plus & Apollo pricing compared to others.

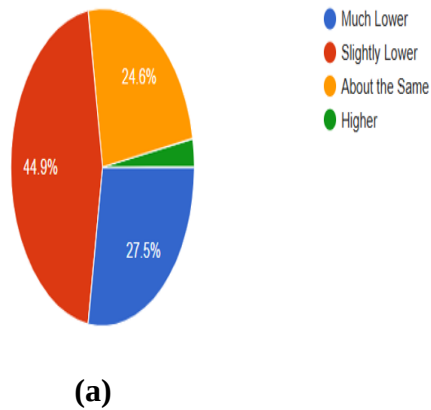
Table 4.9 competitiveness of Med plus & Apollo

Particular	Med plus(a)		Apollo(b)	
	Frequency	Percentage	Frequency	Percentage
Much Lower	19	27.54%	8	10%
Slightly Lower	31	44.93%	29	36.3%
About the same	17	24.64%	27	33.8%
Higher	2	2.90%	16	20%
Total	69	100%	80	100%

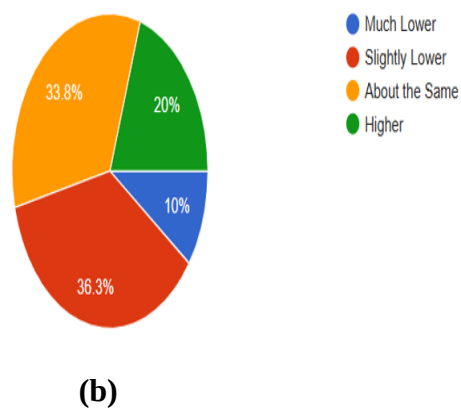
Source: Primary Data.

Chart 4.9(c) Competitiveness of Both Pharmacies.

69 responses



80 responses



Interpretation of Med Plus & Apollo :

From the above Table, the majority of responders observe prices to be lower compared to competitors, with "Slightly Lower" being the most common response (44.93% for Med Plus, 36.3% for Apollo). The least selected option is "Higher", with only 2.9% for Med Plus and 20% for Apollo, indicating that more customers find Apollo's prices relatively higher than Med Plus.

4.10 The Level of Convenience of Shopping at Med plus & Apollo Outlets.

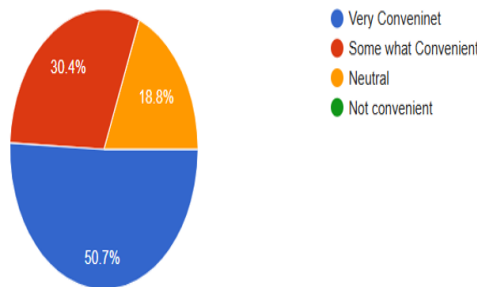
Table 4.10 Convenience of shopping at Med plus & Apollo outlets

Particular	Med plus(a)		Apollo(b)	
	Frequency	Percentage	Frequency	Percentage
Very Convenient	35	50.72%	35	43.8%
Some what Convenient	21	30.43%	28	35%
Neutral	13	18.84%	15	18.8%
Not Convenient	0	0%	2	2.5%
Total	69	100%	80	100%

Source: Primary Data

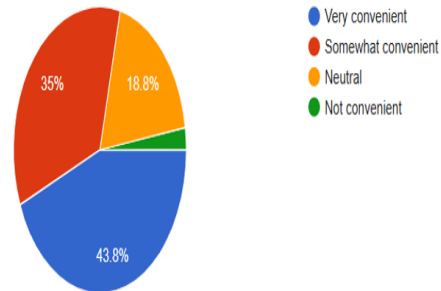
Chart 4.10(c) Convenience of Shopping .

69 responses



(a)

80 responses



(b)

Interpretation of Med plus & Apollo :

50.72% of responders are very convenient shopping with Med plus & 43.8% of responders are very convenient to shop with Apollo. The least selected option is Not Convenient with 0% for Med plus and 2.5% of Apollo, which says that very few customers face difficulties in Shopping.

4.11 Preferred Services at Med plus and Apollo Pharmacy

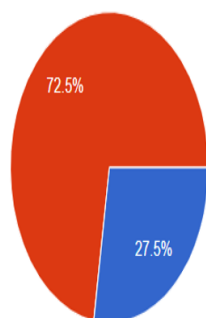
Table 4.11 Preferred services at Med plus & Apollo Pharmacy.

Particular	Med plus(a)		Apollo(b)	
	Frequency	Percentage	Frequency	Percentage
Online Services	19	27.5%	27	33.8%
Offline Services	50	72.5%	53	66.3%
Total	69	100%	80	100%

Source : Primary Data.

Chart 4.11(c) Preferred services.

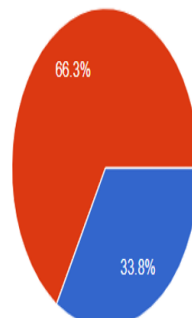
69 responses



(a)

80 responses

● Online Services
● Offline Services



(b)

Interpretation of Med plus & Apollo :

The majority of customers prefer offline services with 72.5% for Med plus and 66.3% for Apollo, the least preferred option is online services, chosen by 27.5% for Med plus and 33.8% for Apollo.

4.12 Experience of Home Sample collection (Diagnostic Services) of Med plus & Apollo.

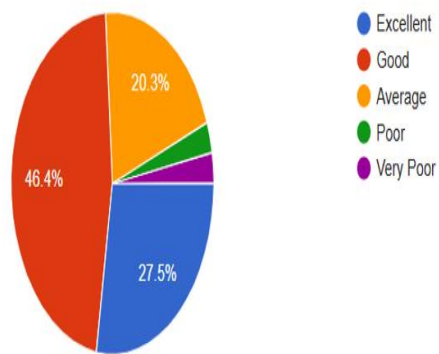
Table 4.12 Med plus & Apollo Home sample collection experience.

Particular	Med Plus(a)		Apollo(b)	
	Frequency	Percentage	Frequency	Percentage
Excellent	19	27.5%	21	26.3%
Good	32	46.4%	41	51.2%
Average	14	20.3%	17	21.3%
Poor	2	2.9%	0	0%
Very Poor	2	2.9%	1	1.2%
Total	69	100%	80	100%

Source : Primary Data.

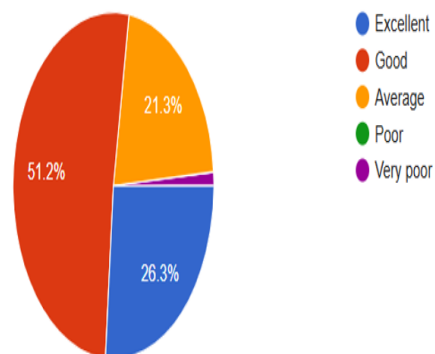
Chart 4.12 (c) Home Sample Collection Experience.

69 responses



(a)

80 responses



(b)

Interpretation of Med plus & Apollo : From above, The majority of customers have a positive home sample collection experience, with the highest ratings in "Good" (46.4% for Med Plus, 51.2% for Apollo). The least selected option is "Very Poor," with only 2.9% for Med Plus and 1.2% for Apollo

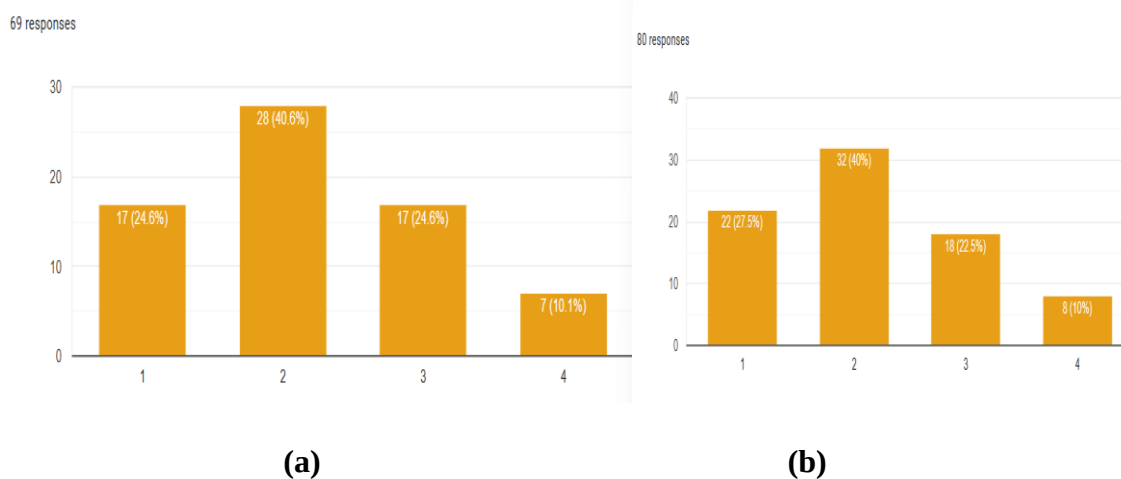
4.13 Rating the User-Friendliness of Med plus & Apollo Online platform.

Table 4.13 Online Platform Usability of Med plus and Apollo.

Particular	Med Plus(a)		Apollo(b)	
	Frequency	Percentage	Frequency	Percentage
1	17	24.64%	22	27.5%
2	28	40.58%	32	40%
3	17	24.64%	18	22.5%
4	7	10.14%	8	10%
Total	69	100%	80	100%

Source : Primary Data.

Chart 4.13 (c) online Platform Usability.



Interpretation of Med Plus & Apollo:

According to the chart, the majority of customers rate the online platform usability as "2" (40.58% for Med Plus, 40% for Apollo), indicating a moderate level of satisfaction. The least selected rating is "4", with 10.14% for Med Plus and 10% for Apollo, suggesting that very few customers are completely dissatisfied with the usability.

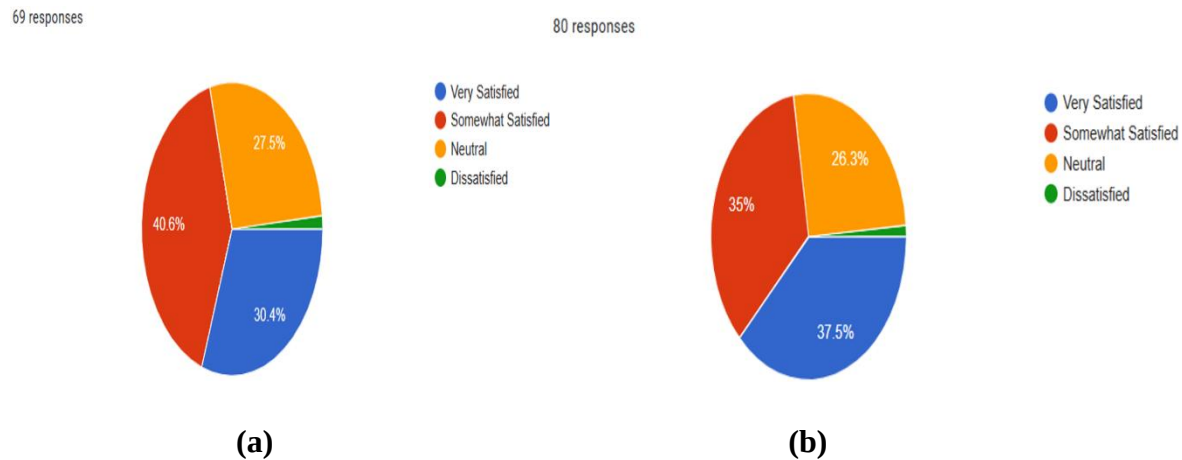
4.14 Satisfaction with Med plus & Apollo Online Delivery Speed.

Table 4.14 Experience with Med Plus& Apollo Delivery Speed.

Particular	Med plus(a)		Apollo(b)	
	Frequency	Percentage	Frequency	Percentage
Very Satisfied	21	30.43%	30	37.5%
Somewhat Satisfied	28	40.58%	28	35%
Neutral	19	27.54%	21	26.3%
Dissatisfied	1	1.45%	1	1.2%
Total	69	100%	80	100%

Source : Primary Data.

Chart 4.14 (c) Experience with Delivery Speed.



Interpretation of Med plus & Apollo:

From the above, 40.58% of respondents are somewhat satisfied by Med plus and 37.5% of respondents are very satisfied by Apollo on experience with delivery speed. The least common response is Dissatisfied with only 1.45% for Med plus and 1.2% for Apollo.

4.15 Comparison of Offline and Online Experiences of Med plus & Apollo.

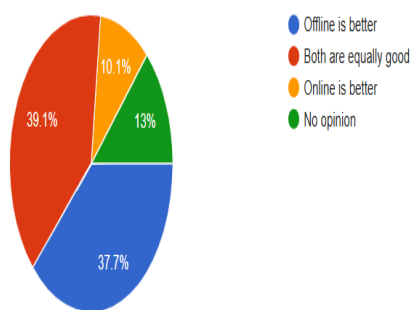
Table 4.15 Comparison of offline and online services in Medplus and Apollo.

Particular	Med plus(a)		Apollo(b)	
	Frequency	Percentage	Frequency	Percentage
Offline is Better	26	37.68	38	47.5
Both are equally good	27	39.13	33	41.3
Online is Better	7	10.14	5	6.3
No opinion	9	13.04	4	5
Total	69	100	80	100

Source : Primary Data.

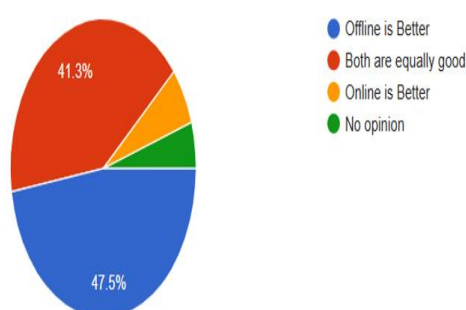
Chart 4.15 (c) Comparison of Offline and Online services

69 responses



(a)

80 responses



(b)

Interpretation of Med plus & Apollo :

From the table, 39.13% of Med plus responders believe both Online and Offline services are equally good , and 47.5% of Apollo responders believe Offline is better service. The least common response is “Online is better” with 10.14% for Med plus and 5% no opinion for Apollo.

4.16 Key factor in choosing Med plus and Apollo

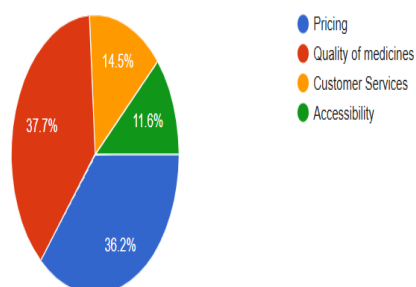
Table 4.16 Key factor of choosing Med Plus and Apollo.

Particular	Med Plus(a)		Apollo(b)	
	Frequency	Percentage	Frequency	Percentage
Pricing	25	36.2%	11	13.8%
Quality of medicines	26	37.7%	51	63.7%
Customer Services	10	14.5%	4	5%
Accessibility	8	11.6%	14	17.5%
Total	69	100%	80	100%

Source :primary Data.

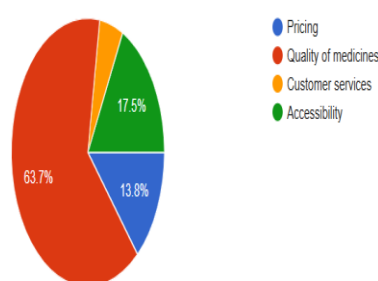
Chart 4.16 (c) Most Important Key Factor of choosing.

69 responses



(a)

80 responses



(b)

Interpretation of Med Plus & Apollo :

For Med Plus, the key factors in choosing the pharmacy are pricing (36.2%) and quality of medicines (37.7%), indicating that both affordability and quality are important to customers. In contrast, for Apollo, the most important factor is quality of medicines (63.7%), followed by accessibility (17.5%). The least important factors across both pharmacies are customer services, 5% for Apollo and Accessibility as factor with 11.6% for Med plus.

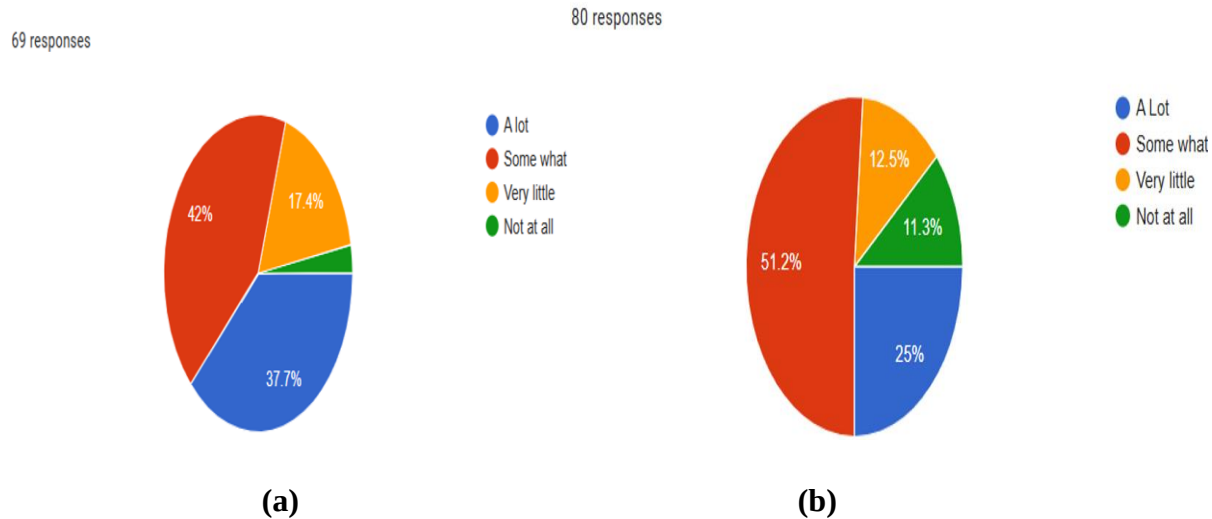
4.17 Impact of Discounts and Pricing on Shopping at Med Plus & Apollo.

Table 4.17 Influence of Discounts and pricing at Med plus & Apollo.

Particular	Med plus(a)		Apollo(b)	
	Frequency	Percentage	Frequency	Percentage
A Lot	26	37.7%	20	25%
Somewhat	29	42%	41	51.2%
Very Little	12	17.4%	10	12.5%
Not at all	2	2.9%	9	11.3%
Total	69	100%	80	100%

Source : Primary Data.

Chart 4.17(c)Influence of Discounts and pricing.



Interpretation of Med Plus & Apollo :

For both Med Plus and Apollo, the majority of customers are somewhat influenced by discounts and pricing, with 42% for Med Plus and 51.2% for Apollo choosing this option. The least influence is observed in the "Not at all" category, with only 2.9% for Med Plus and 11.3% for Apollo.

4.18 Rating the Expertise of Med Plus and Apollo pharmacy staff.

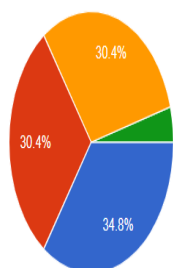
Table 4.18 Staff Expertise Rating of Med Plus & Apollo.

Particular	Med plus(a)		Apollo(b)	
	Frequency	Percentage	Frequency	Percentage
Very Knowledgeable	24	34.78%	43	53.8%
Somewhat Knowledgeable	21	30.43%	27	33.8%
Neutral	21	30.43%	7	8.8%
Not knowledgeable	3	4.35%	3	3.7%
Total	69	100%	80	100%

Source : Primary Data.

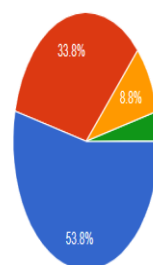
Chart 4.18(c) Staff Expertise Rating.

69 responses



(a)

80 responses



(b)

Interpretation of Med Plus & Apollo :

From the above table, the majority of customers rate the staff as "Very Knowledgeable", with 34.78% for Med Plus and 53.8% for Apollo. The least common response is "Not Knowledgeable", with only 4.35% for Med Plus and 3.7% for Apollo.

4.19 Importance of Location and Accessibility of Med plus and Apollo.

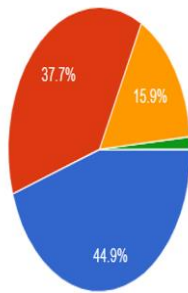
Table 4.19 Med plus & Apollo Location and Accessibility Importance.

Particular	Med plus(a)		Apollo(b)	
	Frequency	Percentage	Frequency	Percentage
Very Important	31	44.93%	34	42.5%
Important	26	37.68%	37	46.3%
Neutral	11	15.94%	7	8.8%
Not Important	1	1.45%	2	2.5%
Total	69	100%	80	100%

Source : Primary Data.

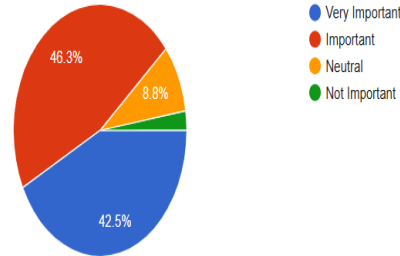
Chart 4.19(c) Location and Accessibility Importance

69 responses



(a)

80 responses



(b)

Interpretation of Med Plus & Apollo:

From the above, 44.93% of Med plus responders consider location and Accessibility as Very Important ,where as 46.3% of responders consider it as important factor. The least selected response is Not important with only 1.45% for Med plus an 2.5% for Apollo.

4.20 Rating the Availability of Healthcare Products at Med Plus and Apollo .

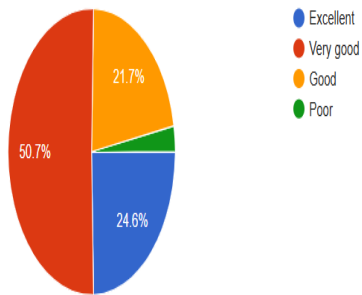
Table 4.20 Med plus & Apollo Healthcare Products Availability Rating.

Particular	Med plus(a)		Apollo(b)	
	Frequency	Percentage	Frequency	Percentage
Excellent	17	24.64%	24	30%
Very good	35	50.72%	44	55%
Good	15	21.74%	10	12.5%
Poor	2	2.90%	2	2.5%
Total	69	100%	80	100%

Source : Primary Data.

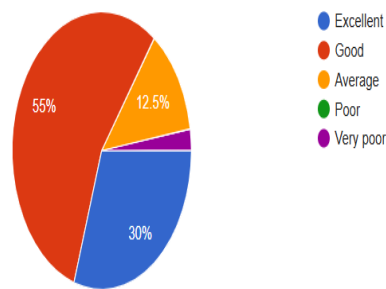
Chart 4.20(c) Healthcare Products Availability Rating.

69 responses



(a)

80 responses



(b)

Interpretation of Med Plus & Apollo :

From the Above pie chart , the majority of customers rate the availability of healthcare products as "Very Good", with 50.72% for Med Plus and 55% for Apollo. The least common response is "Poor", with 2.9% for Med Plus and 2.5% for Apollo.

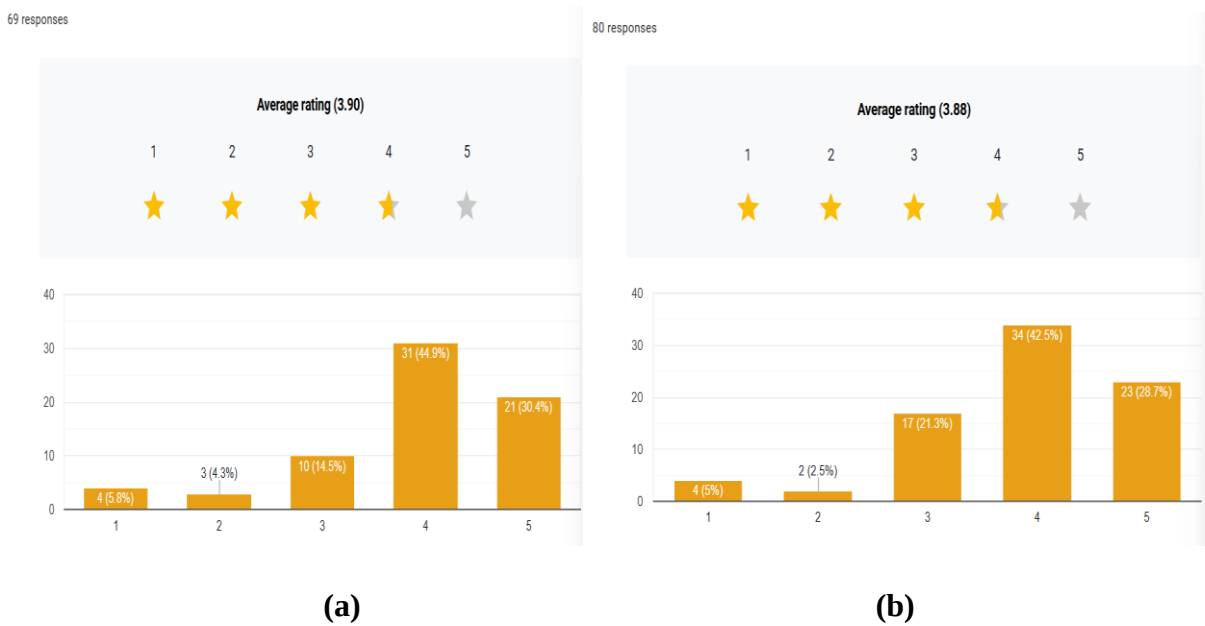
4.21 Rating the services of Med plus and Apollo pharmacy.

Table 4.21 Rating the services of Med plus & Apollo.

Particular	Med plus(a)		Apollo(b)	
	Frequency	Percentage	Frequency	Percentage
1	4	5.80%	4	5%
2	3	4.35%	2	2.5%
3	10	14.49%	17	21.3%
4	31	44.93%	34	42.5%
5	21	30.43%	23	28.7%
Total	69	100	80	100%

Source: Primary Data

Chart 4.21 (c)Rating the Service.



Interpretation of Med Plus & Apollo :

For both Med Plus and Apollo, the majority of customers rate the services as "4", with 44.93% for Med Plus and 42.5% for Apollo, indicating a high level of satisfaction. The least common ratings, with 4.35% for Med Plus and 2.5% for Apollo for "2", and 5.80% for Med Plus and 5% for Apollo for "1".

STATISTICAL ANALYSIS (Using t-Test)

Procedure:

Step 1: Enter the Data in Excel

- 1.Open Microsoft Excel.
- 2.Create a table in 2 separate columns:
 - Column A :Satisfaction levels
 - Column B: Med plus Values
 - Column C: Apollo values

Particular	Med plus	Apollo
Very Satisfied	25	22
Satisfied	30	46
Neutral	13	11
Dissatisfied	1	0
Very Dissatisfied	0	1

Step 2: Open Data Analysis Tool

- 1.Click on the “Data” tab in the Excel ribbon.
- 2.Look for “Data Analysis” in the Top- right section.
- 3.Click on the “Data Analysis” and select “t-Test: Two- samples Assuming Unequal variance”
- 4.Click OK.

Step 3:Input the data

- Variable 1 Range: Select the Med plus values.
- Variable 2 Range: Select the Apollo values.
- Hypothesized Mean Difference:0
- Alpha level: 0.05, Click on Lable Option.
- Output options: Select any range of same page.

Output:-

t-Test: Two-Sample Assuming Unequal Variances

	<i>Med plus</i>	<i>Apollo</i>
Mean	13.8	16
Variance	185.7	360.5
Observations	5	5
Hypothesized Mean Difference	0	
df	7	
t Stat	-0.21049	
P(T<=t) one-tail	0.4196405	
t Critical one-tail	1.8945786	
P(T<=t) two-tail	0.8392811	
t Critical two-tail	2.3646243	

Hypothesis Testing & Decision Making:

3. H₀: There is no significant difference in consumer satisfaction in quality between Med plus and Apollo.
 4. H₁: There is a significant difference in consumer satisfaction in quality between Med plus and Apollo.
- t-Statistic (t Stat): -0.21049
 - P-value (two-tailed test): 0.8392
 - Critical t-value (two-tailed, 5% significance level): 2.3646243

The absolute value of the t-statistic ($|-0.21049|$) is less than the critical t-value (2.3646243). The p-value (0.8392) is greater than 0.05. Since the p-value is large, we fail to reject the null hypothesis.

Conclusion: There is no statistically significant difference in consumer satisfaction between Med Plus and Apollo. This means that, based on the available data, the satisfaction levels for both brands are similar.

CHAPTER V

FINDINGS,SUGGESTIONS AND

CONCLUSION

5.1 Findings:

- Apollo holds slightly higher consumer Preferences , with (53.7%) respondents choosing it over Med Plus (46.3%). The preference is more taken by Apollo's for quality and service, whereas Med Plus attracts price-conscious consumers through affordability & discounts.
- Female customers Mostly prefer Apollo by (53.8%), while Med Plus has a more balanced gender distribution (52.2% male, 46.4% female). This suggests that Apollo's branding and service method attract more to women.
- A Younger age group of below 25 are the majority of customers for both Med plus(84.1%) & Apollo (87.5%), and it was attracted by the students a lot showing that younger consumers giving priority to affordability and accessibility.
- Satisfaction is higher for Apollo (57.5%) compared to Med plus (43.48%), pricing is a more important factor of Med plus and Apollo customers prioritize quality.
- Offline services were preferred the most, with 72.5% of Med Plus and 66.3% of Apollo customers preferring in-store shopping. Apollo leads in online service satisfaction, with 33.8% preferring its online services, compared to 27.5% for Med Plus.
- Customer services are always met by the both services, where with Apollo is more (91.3%) & Both are rated well with Most respondents rating and Availability of goods in Med plus (59.42%) & Apollo (61.3%).
- Med Plus is seen as a budget-friendly option, with 27.54% of respondents considering its prices much lower than competitors, compared to only 10% for Apollo.
- Accessibility remains as factor, with 44.93% of Med Plus customers and 42.5% of Apollo customers considering location very important. Expanding store networks could improve customer reach for both brands
- Apollo is seeming as having better-trained staff, with 53.8% rating them very knowledgeable, compared to 34.78% for Med Plus.
- Among the Services, Offline services are referred for both Med plus & Apollo. However, both online and offline services are equally good.
- Med Plus is seeming as a more cost-effective option, with 44.93% of customers rating its prices as slightly lower than market competitors, while 36.3% of Apollo customers hold the same view.

- Apollo is peak in delivery speed satisfaction, with 37.5% of respondents being very satisfied, compared to 30.43% for Med Plus.
- In Overall Service Ratings Apollo slightly beats Med Plus in higher service ratings (4 and 5 stars).
- Apollo performs slightly better in home sample collection services, with 51.2% of respondents rating it as good, compared to 46.4% for Med Plus.
- Pricing is a more important factor for Med Plus customers, while Apollo customers prioritize quality.

5.2 Suggestions For Pharmacy stores:

- The pharmacies can use the strategy such as OTC Drugs (over the counter drugs- medicines which doesn't require any prescription) & Non drug products for increasing the sales Example - Balms, Diapers, Skin cares, Toiletries etc.
- The pharmacies can provide Health education by displaying the health awareness charts (pictographs).
- There Must be at least 2 Pharmacist with Qualification of (D. Pharm, B. Pharm, M. Pharm & PharmD) & Experience so that they can reduce the incidence of medication errors.
- In Every Pharmacy there must be a patient Counselling Desk to counsel people Regarding their Diseases & Medications.
- Since offline shopping is favored by many, focus on store ambiance, layout, and customer interaction at outlets. Open new stores in less accessible regions to make shopping more convenient for untouched customer bases.

5.3 Conclusion

This study is focused on comparing Med Plus and Apollo to find out which pharmacy is preferred by customers, which provides better service both in stores and online, and what factors influence people's decisions when choosing a pharmacy. To begin with, we identified that Apollo is preferred choice for many customers, due to its reputation for high-quality medicines and the presence of knowledgeable staff with trust upon pharmacy, which boosts its overall market position. Where, Med plus stands out for affordability, attracting price-conscious consumers through discounts. Among both, Apollo offers more healthcare products, making it a convenient as end-to-end service.

Subsequently, we found offline services are mostly preferred for both Med plus and Apollo. Where Apollo is known for its service quality and product accessibility. Med plus is Known for its terms of location. When it comes to online services, Apollo is more user friendly, & faster delivery compared to Med plus, it should be improved in these areas. And the factors such as customer services, staff expertise, convenience and accessibility will play an important role in decision making of customers when choosing a pharmacy. Customers choose Med plus for its affordability and discounts, while Apollo for its product quality and expert guidance.

In the final analysis, Med Plus and Apollo serve different sets of consumer needs. Those looking for cost and convenience have a habit to go with Med Plus, while those with high standards for quality and service have a habit to choose Apollo. By recognizing and accepting these different consumer preferences, the two brands would be in a position to improve their strategies, improve customer satisfaction, and later increase their presence in this competitive pharmaceutical market.

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QUESTIONNAIRE

I) Demographics

Gender:- male, female, other

Age :- below 25 years, 25-35 , 35-45, above 45 years

Education qualifications:- 10th, intermediate, degree, post graduate.

Occupation:- student, private employee, govt employee , unemployes , self business, others

II) section I

What are your preferences to buy medicines from

- A) Apollo
- B) Medplus

III) section II (people who opt for the Med plus)

1) How satisfied are you with the quality of medicines provided by Medplus?

- A. Very satisfied
- B. Somewhat satisfied
- C. Neutral
- D. Dissatisfied

2) How do you rate the availability of medicines at Medplus?

- A. Excellent

- B. Good
- C. Average
- D. Poor

3) Does Medplus meet your expectations for customer service?

- A. Always
- B. Often
- C. Rarely
- D. Never

4) How competitive are Medplus's prices compared to other pharmacies?

- A. Much lower
- B. Slightly lower
- C. About the same
- D. Higher

5) How convenient is it to shop at Medplus outlets?

- A. Very convenient
- B. Somewhat convenient
- C. Neutral
- D. Not convenient

6) what services do you prefer the most in Medplus pharmacy

- Online services
- Offline services.

7) How was your experience with diagnostic services of home sample collection of Medplus ?

- Excellent

- Good
- Average
- Poor
- Very poor

8) How would you rate the user-friendliness of Medplus's online platform?

- A. Excellent
- B. Good
- C. Average
- D. Poor

9) How satisfied are you with the delivery speed of Medplus's online services?

- A. Very satisfied
- B. Somewhat satisfied
- C. Neutral
- D. Dissatisfied

10) How does Medplus's offline experience compare to its online service?

- A. Offline is better
- B. Both are equally good
- C. Online is better
- D. No opinion

11) What is the most important factor for you when choosing Medplus ?

- A. Price
- B. Quality of medicines
- C. Customer service

- D. Accessibility

12) How much do discounts and Pricing influence your decision to shop at Medplus?

- A. A lot
- B. Somewhat
- C. Very little
- D. Not at all

13) How do you rate the pharmacy staff's expertise at Medplus ?

- A. Very knowledgeable
- B. Somewhat knowledgeable
- C. Neutral
- D. Not knowledgeable

14) How important is location and accessibility of Medplus in your choice ?

- Very important
- Important
- Neutral
- Not Important

15) How would you rate the availability of health care products in Medplus ?

- Excellent
- Good
- Average
- Poor
- Very poor

16) What would be your rating for the Medplus services.

- 5
- 4
- 3
- 2
- 1

IV) section III (people who opt for the Apollo)

1) How satisfied are you with the quality of medicines provided by Apollo?

- A. Very satisfied
- B. Somewhat satisfied
- C. Neutral
- D. Dissatisfied

2) How do you rate the availability of medicines at Apollo?

- A. Excellent
- B. Good
- C. Average
- D. Poor

3) Does Apollo meet your expectations for customer service?

- A. Always
- B. Often
- C. Rarely
- D. Never

4) How competitive are Apollo's prices compared to other pharmacies?

- A. Much lower
- B. Slightly lower
- C. About the same
- D. Higher

5) How convenient is it to shop at Apollo outlets?

- A. Very convenient
- B. Somewhat convenient
- C. Neutral
- D. Not convenient

6) what services do you prefer the most in Apollo pharmacy

- Online services
- Offline services.

7) How was your experience with diagnostic services of home sample collection of Apollo ?

- Excellent
- Good
- Average
- Poor
- Very poor

8) How would you rate the user-friendliness of Apollo's online platform?

- A. Excellent
- B. Good
- C. Average
- D. Poor

9) How satisfied are you with the delivery speed of Apollo's online services?

- A. Very satisfied
- B. Somewhat satisfied
- C. Neutral
- D. Dissatisfied

10) How does Apollo's offline experience compare to its online service?

- A. Offline is better
- B. Both are equally good
- C. Online is better
- D. No opinion

11) What is the most important factor for you when choosing apollo ?

- A. Price
- B. Quality of medicines
- C. Customer service
- D. Accessibility

12) How much do discounts and Pricing influence your decision to shop at Apollo?

- A. A lot
- B. Somewhat
- C. Very little
- D. Not at all

13) How do you rate the pharmacy staff's expertise at Apollo ?

- A. Very knowledgeable
- B. Somewhat knowledgeable
- C. Neutral

- D. Not knowledgeable

14) How important is location and accessibility of Apollo in your choice ?

- Very important
- Important
- Neutral
- Not Important

15) How would you rate the availability of health care products in Apollo?

- Excellent
- Good
- Average
- Poor
- Very poor

16) What would be your rating for the Apollo services.

- 5
- 4
- 3
- 2
- 1